



THE UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

UBC Beamer Template

Research presentation

Haonan Bai

The University of British Columbia

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This template is based on [SINTEF Presentation](#) from [Federico Zenith](#) and its derivation [Beamer-LaTeX-Themes](#) from Liu Qilong

CUHK style adaptation contributed by [Rui HU](#)

UBC variation by Haonan Bai (2026). The examples below retain the original template's frame, chapter, side-picture and citation workflows.

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Beamer for UBC slides

1 Introduction



- We assume you can use $\text{\LaTeX}$; if you cannot, [you can learn it here](#)
- Beamer is one of the most popular and powerful document classes for presentations in $\text{\LaTeX}$
- Beamer has also a detailed [user manual](#)
- Here we will present only the most basic features to get you up to speed

Beamer vs. PowerPoint

1 Introduction



Compared to PowerPoint, using $\text{\LaTeX}$ is better because:

- It is not What-You-See-Is-What-You-Get, but What-You-Mean-Is-What-You-Get: you write the content, the computer does the typesetting
- Produces a pdf: no problems with fonts, formulas, program versions
- Easier to keep consistent style, fonts, highlighting, etc.
- Math typesetting in $\text{\LaTeX}$ is the best:

$$i\hbar\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\Psi(\mathbf{r},t) = -\frac{\hbar^2}{2m}\nabla^2\Psi(\mathbf{r},t) + V(\mathbf{r})\Psi(\mathbf{r},t)$$

Getting Started

Selecting the UBC Theme



To start working with the UBC theme, start a $\text{\LaTeX}$ document with the preamble:

Minimum UBC Beamer Document

```
\documentclass{beamer}
\usetheme{ubc}
\begin{document}
\begin{frame}{Hello, world!}
\end{frame}
\end{document}
```

Title page

1 Introduction



To set a typical title page, you call some commands in the preamble:

The Commands for the Title Page

```
\title{Sample Title}  
\subtitle{Sample subtitle}  
\author{First Author, Second Author}  
\institute{The University of British Columbia}  
\date{\today} % Can also be (ab)used for conference name &c.
```

You can then write out the title page with `\maketitle`.

To set a **background image** use the `\titlebackground` command before `\maketitle`; its only argument is the name (or path) of a graphic file.

If you use the **starred version** `\titlebackground*`, the image will be clipped to a split view on the right side of the title slide.

Writing a Simple Slide

It's really easy!



- A typical slide has bulleted lists

Writing a Simple Slide

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- A typical slide has bulleted lists
- These can be uncovered in sequence

Writing a Simple Slide

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Code for a Page with an Itemised List

```
\begin{frame}{Writing a Simple Slide}  
  \framesubtitle{It's really easy!}  
  \begin{itemize}[<+>]  
    \item A typical slide has bulleted lists  
    \item These can be uncovered in sequence  
  \end{itemize}\end{frame}
```

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Changing Slide Style

2 Personalization



- You can select the white or *maincolor* **slide style in the preamble** with `\themecolor{white}` (default) or `\themecolor{main}`
 - You should *not* change these within the document: Beamer does not like it
 - If you *really* must, you may have to add `\usebeamercolor[fg]{normal text}` in the slide
- You can change the **footline colour** with `\footlinecolor{color}`
 - Place the command *before* a new frame
 - Use a dark colour with the white footer text:  `ubcblue` or  `ubcsecondary`
 - Default is no footline; you can restore it with `\footlinecolor{}`
 - Others may work, but no guarantees!
 - Should *not* be used with the *maincolor* theme!

Blocks

2 Personalization



Standard Blocks

The header follows the footline colour; the body uses a neutral background.

```
\begin{block}{title}  
content...  
\end{block}
```

Colour Blocks

Similar to the ones on the left, but you pick the colour. Text will be white by default, but you may set it with an optional argument.

```
\begin{colorblock}[ubcblue]{ubclightblue}{title}  
content...  
\end{colorblock}
```

Use dark text on light backgrounds and white text on dark backgrounds.

Using Colours

2 Personalization



- You can use colours with the `\textcolor{<color name>}{text}` command
- The colours are defined in the `ubccolor` package:
 - Primary colour:  `ubcblue`
 - Secondary blues:  `ubcsecondary`,  `ubcsky`,  `ubclightblue`
 - Template neutrals:  `ubcgrey`,  `ubctext`
 - Semantic alert colour:  `ubcalert`
 - See the [UBC colour guidelines](#) for the official palette. Neutral and alert colours are template choices.
- Do not abuse colours: `\emph{}` is usually enough
- Use `\alert{}` to bring the focus somewhere

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- Do not abuse colours: `\emph{}` is usually enough
- Use `\alert{}` to bring the focus somewhere
- If you highlight too much, you don't highlight at all!

Adding images

2 Personalization



Adding images works like in normal $\text{\LaTeX}$:

Code for Adding Images

```
\usepackage{graphicx}  
% ...  
\includegraphics[width=\textwidth]  
{assets/ubc/ubc-crest-blue}
```



Splitting in Columns

2 Personalization



Splitting the page is easy and common; typically, one side has a picture and the other text:

This is the first column

And this the second

Column Code

```
\begin{columns}
  \begin{column}{0.6\textwidth}
    This is the first column
  \end{column}
  \begin{column}{0.3\textwidth}
    And this the second
  \end{column}
  % There could be more!
\end{columns}
```



Special Slides

2 Personalization

- Chapter slides
- Side-picture slides



Chapter slides

2 Personalization



- Similar to frames, but with a few more options
- Opened with `\begin{chapter}[\<image>]{\<color>}{\<title>}`
- Image is optional, colour and title are mandatory
- Dark backgrounds keep the white chapter text legible:  `ubcblue` or  `ubcsecondary`.
 - It may still be a nice touch to change the footline of following slides to the same color of a chapter slide. Your choice.
- Otherwise, `chapter` behaves just like `frame`.

Side-Picture Slides

2 Personalization

- Opened with `\begin{sidepic}{<image>}{<title>}`
- Otherwise, `sidepic` works just like `frame`



Fonts

2 Personalization



- The paramount task of fonts is being readable
- There are good ones...
 - Use serif fonts only with high-definition projectors
 - Use sans-serif fonts otherwise (or if you simply prefer them)
- ... and not so good ones:
 - Never use monospace for normal text
 - Gothic, calligraphic or weird fonts should always be avoided



- To insert a final slide with the title and final thanks, use `\backmatter`.
 - The title also appears in footlines along with the author name, you can change this text with `\footlinepayoff`
 - You can remove the title from the final slide with `\backmatter[notitle]`
- The aspect ratio defaults to 16:9, and you should not change it to 4:3 for old projectors as it is inherently impossible to perfectly convert a 16:9 presentation to 4:3 one; spacings *will* break
 - The `aspectratio` argument to the `beamer` class is overridden by the UBC theme
 - If you *really* know what you are doing, check the package code and look for the `geometry` class.

Citation

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- you can cite your reference use `\cite{}`, e.g. [Bagla, 2005]. The Reference will be shown in the last page.

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Good Luck!

3 Summary



- Enough for an introduction! You should know enough by now
- Template source and feedback: [UBC-Beamer-Template](#)

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Bagla, J. S. (2005).

Cosmological n-body simulation: Techniques, scope and status.

Current science, pages 1088–1100.

UBC Beamer Template

Thank you for listening!

Any questions?